

Lesson card 1

Everyone should be safe from violence

This lesson card takes 25–35 minutes to deliver.

Step 1: Review content before delivering and ensure you know where to refer people for help locally

Objectives

- Everyone should be safe from all types of violence. A person of any age, any gender and from any background should be protected from violence.
- Laws exist to keep people safe from violence.
- Violence causes all kinds of damage.

Step 2: Questions and activities

What is violence (between people)?

Violence happens when one person uses his or her power to cause harm to another person or persons. This harm can be to the body or the mind, and it can also be through neglecting the needs of another person. Violence can be done to girls, boys, women and men of all ages and backgrounds. A person can also hurt him or herself. This is called self-harm.

Ask three people to volunteer to act out or role-play a violent act. Ask the first person to pretend to hit the second. Ask the third person to stand close by and watch fearfully. Ask the entire group what they would call each person: person one who is doing the hitting, person two who is being hit, and person three who is watching. Explain the role each person has in a violent act. Ask participants to consider what actions they could take, as a bystander, if they saw violence happening.

For each violent act, there is a person inflicting violence, a victim or survivor and often bystanders who see, hear or know of the violence. The person doing the violence needs to stop. The victim/survivor needs to know it is not their fault and get help. The bystander needs to know they have an important role to prevent violence, speak out and get help (once it is safe to do so).

What role does power have in violence? Who has power or lacks power in the community? How can each of us use power in a responsible way?

Violence is a misuse of power. In society, power comes from all kinds of things, like age, gender, position in the community, physical size, etc. No matter where their power comes from, all adults need to use their power in safe ways that do not hurt others.

Ask participants if the answers to the following questions are true or false. In our country there are laws to:

- prevent sexual abuse of women and children? (True)
- protect children from doing chores? (False)
- prevent the physical abuse of girls and boys in schools? (True)
- prevent child or forced marriage? (True)

eCBHFA Violence prevention and response module

Lesson Card 1

Our country has also signed international agreements which give children, women and all people the right to be safe from violence.

The United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child describes the rights of children to be safe from all forms of violence. The Convention on Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women outlines the rights of all women to be safe from all forms of violence.

Who in your community is the most vulnerable to violence? (Volunteers can use the following points as a guide for discussion. Do not read each point to participants)

- Children (people under 18 years of age) are often the smallest, weakest and most dependent members of society.
- Women and girls can be at risk for violence because of their gender.
- Young men can be at particular risk for murder, street violence and suicide.
- Other people like the elderly, people with disabilities, migrants or anyone who is seen as “different” or “less than” others is at high risk.
- In disasters and conflict, the risk of violence can increase because of big changes in the way people live their lives, which bring with them individual, family and community stress and uncertainty. Often, things like the health system and the system which protects people, like the police, are not working well, or not working at all. The place where people normally live may be changed, and not safe to be in. Often, people have to do things that they do not normally do. To cope with the stress, many people turn to harmful practices like taking alcohol or drugs.

List examples of what violence can do to people.

(Ask the group to give suggestions)

- Physical injuries: cuts and bruises, broken bones, scratches.
- Injuries to the emotions (these can take longer to heal than physical injuries): shame, feeling of being powerless, stigma, feeling excluded, mental health problems, betrayal, hopelessness, helplessness, confusion, sadness, anger, crushing of self-esteem, loss of trust.
- Disease/illness like HIV and sexually transmitted diseases (STDs).

Sometimes people say that violence is a private matter and therefore we should not talk about it. What do you think?

Every community wants safety, health and happiness. Sadly, violence against girls, boys, women and men happens in our own communities and around the world. If we do not talk about the problem and find solutions, the problem will not go away.

Step 3: Ask one participant to read the following quote, or a similar local quote, to the group

“I object to violence because when it appears to do good, the good is only temporary; the evil it does is permanent” – Mahatma Gandhi



Lesson card 02

Girls, boys, women, and men need to be treated equally and with respect

This lesson card takes 40–60 minutes to deliver

Step 1: Review content before delivering and ensure you know where to refer people for help locally

Objectives

- Everyone needs to be treated equally and with respect. Age, gender or background should not make a difference.
- Power differences between genders can lead to violence.
- Valuing girls and women the same as boys and men means that individuals, families and communities will be safer and healthier.

Step 2: Questions and activities

What does the image on the card show? (e.g. weight scales with woman and girl on one scale and a man and boy on another)

It shows that women and girls are not always treated equally or with the same respect as men and boys. It is not just women and girls though. Boys and men can also be treated unequally. Whenever someone is treated without respect and as less important and valued as others, it helps create the risk of violence. This is not acceptable.

What does “gender” mean? What about “gender-based violence”? (Small groups)

Gender is society’s way of referring to differences between females and males. Gender is different from a person’s sex because sex refers to their biological or bodily traits, whereas gender is more about the society and culture. Someone’s gender often means that they are expected to play a particular role in society, such as men go out to work and women work in the home. Gender-based violence (or “GBV”) is an umbrella term for any harmful act that results in, or is likely to result in, physical, sexual or psychological harm or suffering to a woman, man, girl or boy on the basis of their gender. GBV is a result of gender inequality and abuse of power.

Are girls, boys, women and men treated equally in your community? If not, why do you think there is a difference? Why do men and boys often treat women and girls as less important and with disrespect?

Differences are often based on beliefs that men and boys are more important and valuable in their society than women and girls. Men and boys may be taught that to be strong and masculine it is normal and acceptable to hit, insult or be sexually aggressive towards girls and women. This is completely wrong and not acceptable. In fact it is dishonourable for men and boys to hurt anyone, whether physically or psychologically.

eCBHFA Violence prevention and response module

Lesson Card 2

What are the biggest challenges for ensuring equality and safety for girls and women in your community? (Make a list)

Do women and girls join in with making decisions in their families and in the community? Do girls have access to school and are they able to get a good education? How many women have a chance to work outside the home? Which health and police services are available to meet the needs of women and girls?

What is the impact when girls are valued less than boys? What is the impact when women are valued less than men? (Discuss in small groups)

There can be many negative consequences when girls and women are valued less than boys and men. For example:

- Safety: without proper education, basic needs and support, women and girls can be at higher risk of violence in families, schools, and workplaces, and girls can be at higher risk of child marriage or early or forced marriage
- Health: the stress that violence brings can cause bad health as it damages the nervous and immune systems, which can bring lifelong problems and possible early death
- Human potential: families and communities may not develop their full potential because people are hurt, scared or in fear.
- Economic: families do not earn as much money as they could if women and girls were valued and educated like men and boys

Why are women, girls and boys at risk of gender-based violence in disasters?

What often happens in a disaster is that the usual way of life is changed. There may be a lot of personal and community stress with people turning to alcohol and drugs to cope with their problems. The surroundings may be unsafe, and there may not be safe food and water. Often men and women, boys and girls, have to do things they do not do usually. The normal systems, such as health and safety, may be not working well, or not working at all. The risk of violence because of all these points is greater. But it should be preventable, and all communities should work to address the problem of violence in disasters.

Which actions can men and boys take to increase the safety of girls and women (and other boys and men)?

Men and boys can learn not to behave in violent ways in their families, schools, workplaces and in the community. They can learn to understand and control their anger. They can speak up about non-violence and talk to other men and boys to change their behaviour so it is non-violent. They can intervene (when it is safe) to stop other men and boys who are being violent, and they can work with women and girls to find local solutions to violence. Most of all, men and boys can be models of respectful and non-violent behaviour in their own dealings with other people to show how honourable men behave.

What can you change in your own life to value and respect girls and women and boys and men equally? What can be done in your family? What can be changed in your community? How will you personally help make these changes? (Participants can be invited to make a pledge/commitment to a specific action)

Step 3: Ask a participant to read the following quote, or a similar local quote, to the group

"Women hold up half the sky" (Chinese proverb)



Lesson card 03

Hitting another person is harmful and abuses their human rights

This lesson card takes 40–60 minutes to deliver

Step 1: Review content before delivering and ensure you know where to refer people for help locally

Objectives

- It is harmful when people experience, see or hear physical violence in their family or community.
- There are many ways to resolve problems and conflict that do not include physical violence.

2: Questions and activities

Why do you think the people in the pictures may be upset? (Discuss in small groups)

In either picture, the people may be upset for many reasons. Whatever the reasons, hitting other people is not good for all involved; no one should have to experience being hit or see or hear other people being hit. It is unsafe, unnecessary and harmful.

Why do we (adults) hit other people? Why do we hit children? (Ask the group)

- Adults hit children or other adults out of anger, stress, fear or because their society values the other gender less. This is called gender-based discrimination. They also hit to try to change someone else's behaviour, such as when a child is naughty.
- Hitting children or adults does not change their behaviour in the long term but it can cause injuries, fear, serious upset, and loss of trust.
- There are better, safer and more effective alternatives to hitting other people.

Look at the image on the right and left. Whose fault is this? Why?

- The violence is not the fault of the person being hit. The people doing the hitting are responsible for their own actions.
- The people being hit may have made a mistake or they may have done nothing at all. Whatever happened, violence is not the solution.
- If they made a mistake, they can be told why it was a mistake without being hurt. Hitting is not safe or effective or necessary.
- No matter what the person has done, they do not deserve to be hit.

When a person is hit or exposed to violence (like in a family), what is the impact?

- Physical injuries like bruises, cuts, scars or burns.
- Emotional injuries like fear of being hit again, seeing someone else (like people they care about) being hit, confusion, shame, anger, feeling that other people disapprove of them, deep distress, powerlessness, guilt or feeling responsible for the violence.
- Loss of self-esteem and trust.
- Illness resulting from injuries.

eCBHFA Violence prevention and response module

Lesson Card 3

When a child is hit or watches or hears violence what lessons do they learn?

Children can learn that violence is an acceptable way to solve problems, that nothing happens to the person who is violent, that violence is ok, and it is fine to hit someone who is smaller, weaker or less powerful. These are all unacceptable messages.

In what situations do you sometimes get upset and lose control? How can you calm yourself down? (Discuss in small groups)

Everyone gets upset and feels stress sometimes (especially in disasters and crises). But that does not have to lead to violence. Anger and stress can be like a volcano. Once we start to feel anger and stress levels climb, we need to calm down so these feelings do not increase. Otherwise, we can lose control and say or do things that are hurtful to others.

Some ways to calm down include counting to ten (or if you are very angry counting to 50 or 100), breathing deeply, removing yourself from the person or place that is causing you anger, understanding the things that can start your anger or stress, and thinking about how you would want to be treated if you made someone else angry.

What can we (adults) do, other than hitting children or other adults?

Adults should remember these tips:

- Only correct another when you are calm; do not correct in an angry way.
- Go away from people with whom you are upset when you are very angry. Only return to talk to them when you are calm.
- Use positive language; using hurtful words and insults is not effective or necessary.
- Model the behaviour you would want your children, family and friends to follow.
- Hitting people is not effective. It injures the other person physically and emotionally.

If you see someone else hitting a child or an adult, what can you do?

Taking action is not always easy. But if no one does anything the violence can continue. When people watching violence do take action, violence is much more likely to stop. If it is safe, you can speak up to calm down the situation, make it clear that violence is not acceptable or talk to someone else in your home or community who can help.

If someone does experience physical or domestic violence, who in your community can help? (Ask participants to list health, legal and advice services in their communities). What practical actions can you take as a community to improve these services?

Step 3: Ask participants if they can share a local quote or song that summarizes the key messages



Lesson card 04

Sexual and gender-based violence should never be tolerated, it is a violation of our basic human rights: dignity and safety

This lesson card takes 25–35 minutes to deliver

Step 1: Review content before delivering and ensure you know where to refer people for help locally

Objectives

- Sexual and gender-based violence (SGBV) against girls, boys, women or men is cruel and degrading.
- Women and children – girls and boys – are especially vulnerable to SGBV.
- Bystanders and men have an important role in preventing and responding to SGBV.

Step 2: Questions and activities

What do you think is happening in these pictures? (Ask participants to give suggestions)

The touching in both of the pictures is unsafe and unacceptable. No one should experience sexual violence; not girls or boys, women or men.

What actions does sexual violence include? (Ask participants to give examples)

Sexual violence can happen through direct touches, for example:

- any sexual act against an adult who does not want or agree to it; this includes rape (forcing someone to have sex against their will) and touching the sexual parts of a person's body
- any sexual act between a child and an adult. Sexual contact with children is against the law and not allowed
- trading or selling people for sexual reasons
- child, early or forced marriage

Sexual violence also includes actions that do not involve direct touching, for example:

- unwanted sexual comments or gestures, being forced to look at sexual pictures (online, through magazines, etc.)
- any sexual comments or gestures to children or showing sexual images to children

Who, in the picture, could the person hurting the others be? (Ask participants to give examples)

The adult could be anyone; a parent, a relative, husband, boyfriend, teacher, community leader. No matter who they are, what they are doing is unacceptable and must stop.

eCBHFA Violence prevention and response module

Lesson Card 4

Why would an adult try to talk a child into keeping a secret about SGBV? (Ask participants)

When people hurt children using unsafe sexual touches they can try to make the child keep the touching a secret, so no-one else will find out. An adult may try to trick, shame, threaten or force a child into keeping a secret about sexual violence. This is unacceptable. All adults have a responsibility to keep children safe.

Where could these situations (in the images) be happening? (Ask participants)

These situations can be happening anywhere; in a home, a school, at work, in the community. It does not matter where they are happening, they are unsafe and must stop.

Are there certain situations, places or times that the risk of SGBV is highest? What can we do to make these safer?

In disasters especially, the risk of violence can increase because of stress on individuals, families and communities which grows while protective social support systems can become weakened.

What can we do in these situations to keep children safe? What about adults?

To help keep children safe, adults can teach their children that no one should touch them in unsafe ways and that if someone does try to touch them in an unsafe way they can say "NO!"; run away, tell someone they trust and keep telling until someone helps them.

If you see or hear someone being hurt, what immediate action can you take?

Taking action is not always easy. But if no-one does anything the violence can continue. When people who see violence happen do take action, it is much more likely to stop. If it is safe, try to get the person being hurt to safety, get help immediately from the help services in the community, and follow local laws.

Why do people, especially men, hurt other people sexually? What role do men have to prevent SGBV?

Although men or women can inflict SGBV, most of the time it is inflicted by men. Men need to understand that women, girls and boys must be treated with dignity and safety at all times. Men must speak out against SGBV by other men and show leadership by modelling safe behaviours in their own families and communities. It is dishonourable, and not masculine, to hurt other men, women or children.

If someone does experience SGBV, who in your community can help? (Ask participants to list health, legal and advice services). What practical action can your community take to prevent and respond to SGBV? Are there existing actions you can strengthen?

Step 3: Ask participants to take a quiet moment to consider the many ways that SGBV can alter a person's life



Lesson card 05

Psychological violence is damaging to a person's self-esteem and often has long-lasting consequences

This lesson card takes 25–35 minutes to deliver

Step 1: Review content before delivering and ensure you know where to refer people for help locally

Objectives

- Psychological violence is a form of violence.
- Psychological violence can crush a person's self-esteem. Emotional scars can take longer to heal than physical bruises.

Step 2: Questions and activities

What is happening in the pictures?

In both pictures, one person looks very upset and is crushing another person's self-esteem through words and gestures. What is happening in both of these images is unsafe/damaging.

Call out examples of different ways that we can crush another person's self-esteem.

- Through words, gestures, or other actions that are meant to hurt and which insult, reject, or imply that the other person is unimportant or somehow less valuable.
- The underlying message of emotional abuse is always the same: "You are not good enough!"
- Emotional violence is also a part of all other forms of violence (physical, sexual, and neglect). For example, when a child is physically abused, it has a physical impact, but also an emotional impact. The scars from emotional abuse can take longer to heal than bruises or injuries.
- When someone sees or hears violence against someone else, that also causes emotional harm and deep distress. It is damaging..

Why do people treat one another in these ways? What role does discrimination have?

People may treat one another in emotionally violent ways because they are upset or frustrated, think it will change another person's behaviour, or simply because that is how they have learnt to handle conflict or stress. Whatever the reasons, crushing a person's self-esteem is damaging. Everyone deserves to be treated with dignity, respect and safety.

eCBHFA Violence prevention and response module

Lesson Card 5

People can also act violently because of discrimination based on gender, disability, religion, beliefs or the other person's background. Violence based on gender discrimination – especially against girls and women – is very common. Emotional violence is unacceptable.

Is it emotional violence any time an adult yells at a child?

Not necessarily. Emotional violence is a constant/regular attack on someone's self-esteem. In general, at some time everyone gets upset or raises their voice. What is unhealthy is when one person constantly crushes another person's self-esteem. At other times, someone may yell because they are actually protecting the child, for example to stop them running in front of a vehicle.

What is the impact of emotional violence?

Emotional violence can crush a person's self-esteem, reduce their ability to form healthy relationships, to concentrate and cope with stress, and it can cause deep long-lasting distress and have an impact on their overall health.

What can we do, even when we are very upset, to avoid treating other people in emotionally violent ways?

First, it is important to calm down. Count to ten (or if you are very upset count to 50 or 100), breathe deeply, remove yourself from the person or place that is causing you distress, understand what starts your own stress and anger, and think about how you would want to be treated if you upset somebody else.

If your own feelings about people's gender, age or ability cause you to be emotionally violent, examine those feelings and remember that you should treat everyone with respect and dignity.

In disasters, it is especially important to manage your stress. Do not act violently from anger or fear, and do not rely on using harmful alcohol or drugs to cope.

If a child is misbehaving, how can adults correct him or her without being violent?

Adults can remember these tips:

- Only correct when you are calm. Do not correct if you are angry.
- Separate yourself from a child when you are very upset.
- Use positive language. Using hurtful words is ineffective and damaging.
- Model the behaviour you want children to follow.
- Crushing a child's self-esteem through words, gestures and other actions does not change a child's behaviour. It only makes a child feel bad and worthless.

If someone does experience emotional violence, who in your community can help? (Ask participants to list health, legal and advice services). What practical action can your community take to prevent and respond to emotional violence? Are there existing actions that you can strengthen?

Step 3: Ask participants to summarize the key messages in one sentence



Lesson card 06

Harming yourself hurts you and those you care about

This lesson card takes 25–35 minutes to deliver

Step 1: Review content before delivering and ensure you know where to refer people for help locally

Objectives

- Self-harm is a common problem around the world that can be prevented.
- Self-harm often carries stigma (being disapproved of by other people and being treated as less) that can be a barrier to prevention.

Step 2: Questions and activities

What is happening in the pictures?

In each of the pictures, someone is hurting their own body. The person has reached a point where they believe that hurting their own body is the only solution to their sadness, illness or loneliness. They are losing, or have lost, hope.

What are the different ways that someone can hurt their own body?

Unfortunately, there are many ways a child or adult might hurt their own body. Someone might cut their skin, inhale toxins, consume poisons, use weapons against themselves or try to stop breathing.

How common do you think self-harm is?

Self-harm through suicide is the leading cause of violent deaths in the world. Over 800,000 people die of suicide each year. The populations at greatest risk are commonly the elderly and young people. In many places, men are the most vulnerable to ending their own lives, although women also can have high rates of self-harm and suicide. However, because of the stigma and because it is often illegal, suicide deaths are often hidden. They are kept secret and the true scope of suicide and self-harm is hard to measure.

Important: for every suicide that succeeds, there are many more people who attempt suicide.

What could cause someone to hurt their own body? What are common risks?

There is no single cause when a person hurts their own body. There can be many reasons that combine to make someone more likely to do it. Having tried to commit suicide in the past is the single most important risk factor for future suicide attempts.

eCBHFA Violence prevention and response module

Lesson Card 6

Common risks can include:

- difficulty in getting health care
- easy availability of the means for self-harm (poisons, weapons, etc.)
- media reporting that makes suicide a sensational news item
- stigma against people who ask for help or who have mental health, deep distress, or problems with drugs or alcohol.

Other risks include experiencing violence in the past, having chronic pain, living through disaster or conflict, a family history of suicide, mental illness, feeling isolated or discriminated against and having difficult personal relationships.

Ultimately, self-harm becomes possible when a child or adult has lost hope and feels hurting their own body is the only solution.

Why is stigma a problem in preventing and responding to self-harm?

Unfortunately, stigma is a common and harmful reaction to self-harm, including suicide, around the world. Religious beliefs, the culture and local laws can create an environment where people feel fear or shame to speak to others about their own self-harm thoughts. When these thoughts are not shared, the risk of harm increases.

Sometimes people are afraid that encouraging people to talk about self-harm can increase the chances of it happening. What do you think about this?

In fact, because there is so much stigma about self-harm, many people have no-one to talk to about their self-harm thoughts. So, when someone who is considering self-harm does have someone to confide in, instead of increasing risk, talking to someone can help make a person feel more connected to others, feel less alone, explore options other than self-harm, and have more time to reconsider their plans. Talking openly about self-harm can help prevent injuries or death.

What action can communities take to reduce the risk of self-harm, including suicide?

Communities can take many actions including raising awareness about the problem. They can work to reduce access to methods for self-harm (by putting barriers on bridges or limiting the availability of guns, alcohol and poisons). They can work with the media to encourage responsible reporting and to give publicity to helplines, and they can support health care workers to respond.

Who in your community can help to prevent self-harm or to respond if people ask for assistance? (Ask participants to list health and advice/support services). How can access to those be improved so people feel less stigma? What other practical actions can your community take to prevent and respond to self-harm?

Step 3: Ask participants to consider

How they would respond if someone told them about self-harm. Do they feel prepared to listen and refer? What support and training do participants need to feel prepared?



Lesson card 07

Violence can be prevented – help and laws exist

This lesson card takes 25–35 minutes to deliver

Step 1: Review content before delivering and ensure you know where to refer people for help locally

Objectives

- Help exists for children and adults who have been hurt by violence.
- It is essential to have a survivor-centred approach to handling disclosures of violence.
- If a Red Cross Red Crescent volunteer is made aware that violence is happening, they can listen to the person and refer them to the help services.

Step 2: Questions and activities

Imagine a child has been hurt by violence, maybe even by someone they know and trust. Why might it be hard for them to tell another person they are being hurt?

The child may:

- be afraid that if they tell, they will get into trouble or something bad will happen because they have been told to keep it a secret
- be scared something bad will happen to someone they care about
- be dependent (financially, emotionally, etc.) on the person who is hurting them
- feel confused or unhappy because they trusted the person who hurt them, or even like or love the person who hurt them
- be upset that other people know or will know what happened, feel ashamed or embarrassed
- think it is their own fault

It can take a lot of courage for children, or any person, to disclose violence. It is important that people know that when someone hurts them it is not their own fault!

How can we help a child or adult who has been hurt? What is a survivor-centred approach? (Ask for suggestions from the group)

The priority is the safety of the person. It is essential to have a survivor-centred approach to handling disclosures of violence. This means: everything begins with the experiences of the survivor. These experiences determine the need and the needs determine the services required. The safety of the survivor is a priority and confidentiality is maintained at all times.

eCBHFA Violence prevention and response module

Lesson Card 7

Some steps that can be taken: **Listen and refer to local help services.** Specifically,

- Listen to the person and show empathy. "I am sorry this happened to you."
- Comfort the person and take the person to a safe place. "It's not your fault."
- If the disclosure involves a child, report immediately to a helping person. "Let's get some help."
- Ensure that no other person is at risk of being hurt in the same way and/or by the same person.

The difference between adults and children is that children must be supported to get help according to local child protection laws. For adults, it is their own choice whether they want support or not.

If someone is being hurt, who could they talk to in your community?

People who can help in a community can be anyone the person trusts: friends, family, relatives, health workers, neighbours or community leaders.

If you see or hear someone being hurt, what action can you take?

Taking action is not always easy. But if no-one does anything, violence can continue. When people are aware that violence is happening and then take action, violence is much more likely to stop. If it is safe, try to get the person being hurt to safety, get help immediately, speak up to bring attention to the violence, make it clear that violence is unacceptable and must stop immediately and talk to someone else in the home or community who can help.

If you do provide support to someone who has experienced violence, make sure you also take care of yourself. Handling disclosures of violence and making reports can be stressful and emotionally exhausting. Take time to discuss your feelings, take rest, and do things that you find healing or relaxing.

What practical actions can your community take to make everyone – women, men, girls and boys – safe from violence? What action can you take in your own family? What changes can you make as a person to be non-violent?

- Examine yourself. How do you control your own anger, jealousy, fear and stress? How do you ensure you have healthy relationships?
- How do you behave when you have been drinking? Do you lose control?
- Everyone has the ability to control how they use their own power.
- We can choose to use our power to hurt others and make them feel small, or we can use our power to help and protect others.

Step 3: Ask participants to state the most important lesson they have learnt from the session. Which one action can they take right away to make their community safer?

